Conditional type 1

Objective: To express real and possible situations in the future and their likely results using the first conditional.

The idea in two lines: The first conditional links a possible condition to its probable result: **if + present simple, will + base form**. We use it for predictions, warnings, promises and advice.

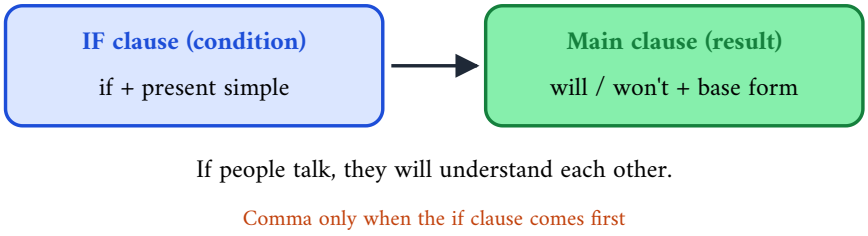


Figure 1: The structure of the first conditional: a possible condition leads to a probable future result.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **Structure:** If + present simple, will + base form: *If we work together, we will build peace.*
2. **Order:** the main clause can come first with no comma: *We will build peace if we work together.*
3. **Meaning:** a **real or likely** situation in the present or future.
4. **Unless** = if … not: *Unless we stop wars, many people will suffer.*
5. **Other forms** in the result: a modal (*can, may, should*) or an imperative: *If you see violence, call for help.*
6. **No will** in the if clause: the condition is always in the present.

🟢 Examples

1. Complete: "If countries (respect) each other, there (be) less conflict." **Answer:** If countries *respect* each other, there *will be* less conflict.

2. Join with *unless*: "If you don't apologise, he won't forgive you." **Answer:** *Unless you apologise*, he won't forgive you. **Explanation:** unless already contains the negative.
3. Correct: "If she will come, we will discuss the problem." **Answer:** If she *comes*, we will discuss the problem.

🟠 Common BAC mistakes

- Putting **will** in the if clause.
- Using a double negative with **unless**: *Unless you don't study* ×.
- Forgetting the third-person -s in the if clause: *If he come* × → *If he comes* ✓.
- Confusing type 1 (likely) with type 2 (if + past, would: imaginary).

🟡 Quick review

- If + present, will + verb.
- Real, possible future result.
- Unless = if … not.
- Comma when the if clause starts the sentence.
- No will after if.

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